

Express: Specialist III Position Alignment & Interview Strategy

Metadata

- **Candidate:** Joanne Jeremie, MA (TESOL), BA (Ed)
- **Target Position:** Children and Youth Program Specialist III (EIS) (Position #124503)
- **Expressed At:** 2026-05-28T01:47:00-10:00

1. Executive Position Pitch

Joanne Jeremie is a **Master Educator and technical documentation specialist** with over a decade of experience designing evidence-based instruction, leading compliance-driven educational programs, and facilitating state/district professional development.

Her profile aligns strongly with the DOH Early Intervention Section's need for a program specialist who can lead the **Comprehensive System of Personnel Development (CSPD)** (75% time) and perform rigorous **Self-Assessment Monitoring (SAM)** quality assurance (20% time). By combining deep special education foundations (Bilingual SPED/IEP) with advanced digital capabilities (Generative AI & Data Analytics), Joanne brings a modern, high-impact, and culturally competent approach to early childhood support services in Hawaii.

2. Key Target Narratives per Dimension

Consultation & Training (PD: 75% focus)

- **The Narrative:** *"I don't just deliver training; I build institutional capacity. As a former Director of Studies, UH Lecturer, and MLL Coordinator, I have designed district-level professional development curricula (such as the Storybook AI initiative) and authored comprehensive coordinator manuals that enable teams to execute their roles flawlessly from day one. I am ready to lead needs assessment surveys and design rigorous, family-centered personnel development programs for EIS."*

On-Site Monitoring & Record Auditing (PD: 20% focus)

- **The Narrative:** *"As an MLL Coordinator, my role was defined by compliance and quality assurance. I have managed program overhauls that successfully exited student groups by tracking progress via data-driven MTSS frameworks and WIDA assessments. I am highly comfortable using checklists to audit individual development records (like IEPs and IFSPs) and entering diagnostic data into database tools (like the SAM tool) to ensure strict adherence to state and federal timelines."*

Special Education & Early Intervention Synergy

- **The Narrative:** *"My experience as a Bilingual Spanish SPED teacher gave me deep, practical experience working with families to implement Individualized Education Programs (IEPs). I understand the coordination required between special education staff, general practitioners, and families. I am eager to apply this knowledge to birth-to-three services under IDEA Part C, ensuring our infants and toddlers receive compliant, evidence-based, and compassionate support."*

3. Recommended Resume Optimizations (Tailoring Guide)

1. **Highlight the SPED/Bilingual Teacher Role:** Move the *"Bilingual Spanish & ESL SPED Teacher"* position higher or elaborate on its connection to family-centered care and IEP compliance to mirror the PD's focus on special health needs and Early Intervention.

2. **Elevate Database & Data Tracking Language:** Explicitly mention database-driven progress monitoring (using spreadsheets/databases to track timelines) in past coordinator roles to match the PD's Excel/Access/SAM requirements.
 3. **Focus on "Birth to Five" Adaptability:** Add a line in the Qualifications Summary highlighting a strong foundation in child development and childhood education (K-5 and preschool frameworks).
 4. **Authoritative Manual Creation:** Emphasize the *"MLL Coordinator Manual"* as evidence of her ability to write training evaluation reports, procedural guidelines, and personnel manuals.
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4. Interview Preparation Questions & Responses

Q1: This role is focused on infants and toddlers (ages 0-3). Your experience is primarily K-5 and higher ed. How will you transition your skills?

- **Response:** *"While my primary classroom teaching has been K-5 and higher education, my specialized training in Special Education (SPED) and second language acquisition is deeply rooted in early childhood development. The core principles of early intervention—being family-centered, strengths-based, and culturally responsive—are the exact principles I have used to design newcomer family programs and MLL initiatives. Furthermore, the administrative, compliance, and training development skills required for the CSPD framework are age-agnostic and will translate seamlessly."*

Q2: How do you handle program monitoring and compliance tracking when multiple timelines are in play?

- **Response:** *"Compliance tracking is about zero-defect organization. In my previous coordinator roles, I monitored student exits, SIQ teacher certifications, and MTSS intervention cycles. I leverage database entries, strict checklist audits, and automated trackers to ensure no milestone is missed. I am very comfortable with database tools like the Self-Assessment Monitoring (SAM) database and will ensure EIS records are 100% compliant with IDEA Part C timeline requirements."*